GRAND VALLEY STATE UNIVERSITY

Module 4 Lecture - States of Consciousness

Introductory Psychology

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“I don’t mind not knowing. It doesn’t scare me.” — Richard P. Feynman

1 Overview and Introduction

1.1 Textbook Learning Objectives

- Understand what is meant by consciousness
- Explain how circadian rhythms are involved in regulating the sleep-wake cycle, and how circadian cycles can be disrupted
- Discuss the concept of sleep debt
- Describe areas of the brain involved in sleep
- Understand hormone secretions associated with sleep
- Describe several theories aimed at explaining the function of sleep
- Name and describe three theories about why we dream
- Differentiate between REM and non-REM sleep
- Describe the differences between the three stages of non-REM sleep
- Understand the role that REM and non-REM sleep play in learning and memory
- Describe the symptoms and treatments of insomnia
- Recognize the symptoms of several parasomnias
- Describe the symptoms and treatments for sleep apnea
- Recognize risk factors associated with sudden infant death syndrome (SIDS) and steps to prevent it
- Describe the symptoms and treatments for narcolepsy

1.2 Instructor Learning Objectives

- Understand how consciousness is better described as range of states, rather than simply "on" or "off"
- Appreciate the complex biological and systemic changes at play in sleep regulation

1.3 Introduction

- Have you ever been in the back of a classroom, watching a boring lecture, slowly feeling yourself falling ____________________?
  - We've all been there…
  - All of us have had the ____________________ of being wide awake, being tired/fatigued, being asleep, etc.

Discuss: Write about how many hours of sleep do you get each night, and if you regularly feel awake or tired? This is a little preview of what we'll be talking about today

- There are other states of conciousness, related to use of specific substances or ________ disassociation
  - These will not be a major focus in this lecture, relative to ________

2 What is Consciousness?

2.1 Introduction

Important

There is a philosophical debate to have on what exactly 'consciousness' is - we are going to try to stay more focused on a factual concrete description today, but it is worth reading into more!

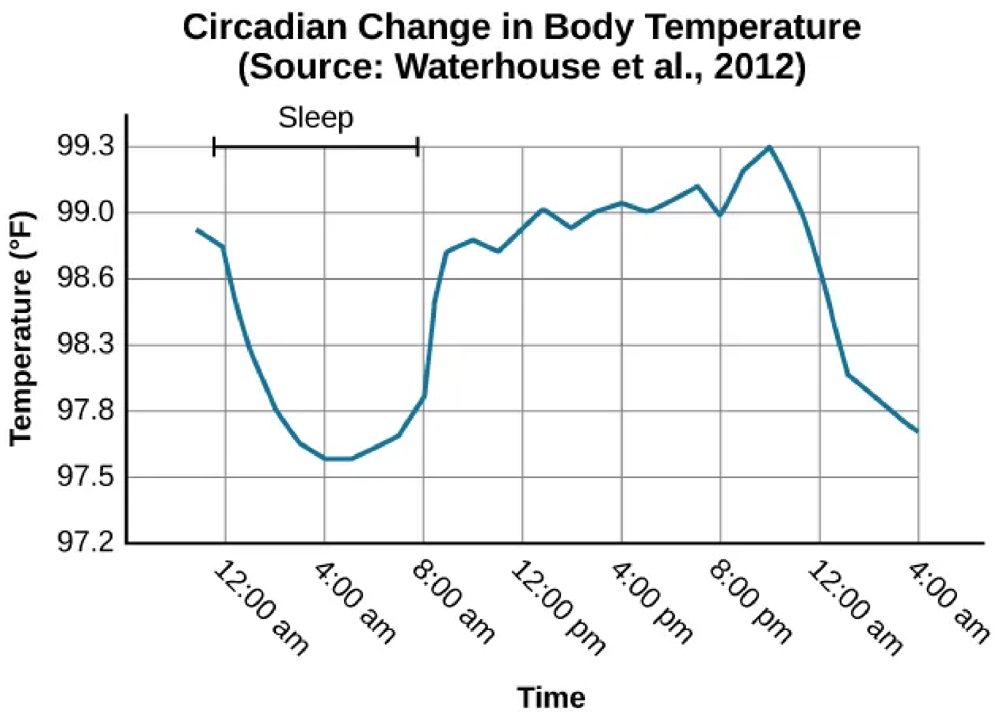
- **Consciousness** is our state of ________ of our environment, perceptions, and thoughts.
  - On the other hand, we have the state of being ________ or being un-alert to the world around us
- When we are ________, we are usually at least reasonably conscious of our surroundings, but when we are **sleeping** we are more-or-less completely ________
  - But between these two states, we have things like ________, daydreaming, being intoxicated with substances, being knocked unconscious due to injury, etc.

2.2 Biological Rhythms

- Our bodies ________ on many rhythmic biological processes:

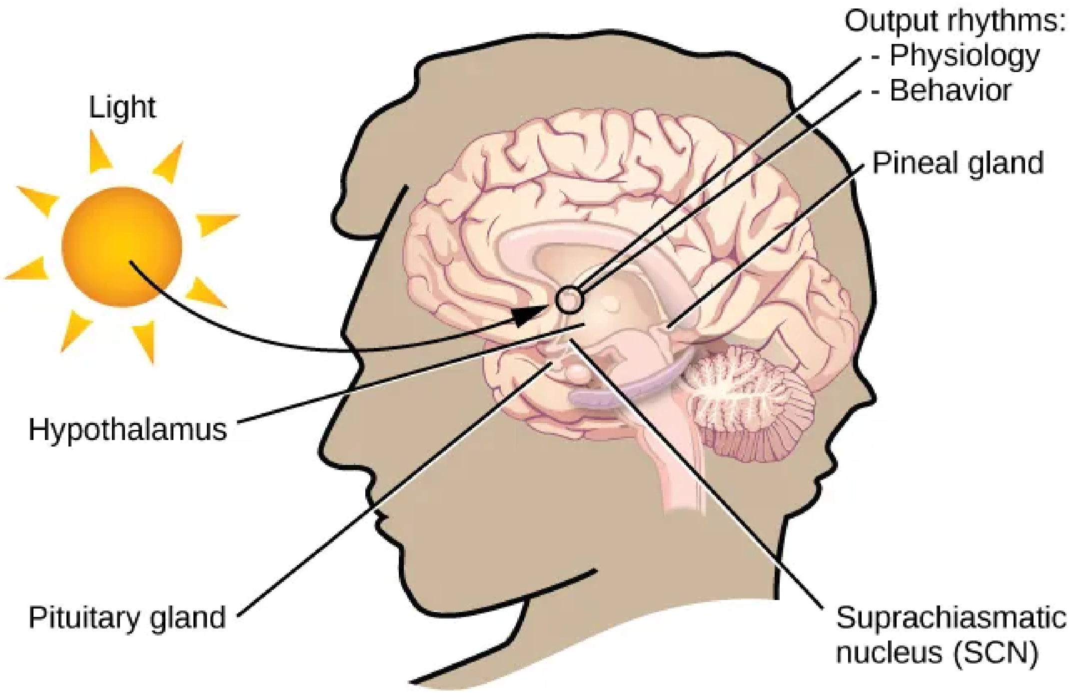
- Each of these is a **circadian rhythm**, or one that has a ____________ function over 24 hours
- Sleep and awake
- Body temperature natural fluctuations
- Menstrual cycles
- Many others

> **Important**
>
> Many of these cycles tie back in nicely to biopsychology, but we will primarily focus on sleep and its biological basis for this lecture.



- Our bodies attempt to maintain **homeostasis**, which is a restful, optimal state in which ____________, cells, substances, and other bits of our body are in balance
  - Homeostasis is our ____________ state, which is healthy for us
  - All of these ____________ and circadian rhythms help this process of homeostasis
- Our brain has built-in ____________ called the **suprachiasmatic nucleus (SCN)** in the hypothalamus
  - However, one nuance of this structure is that it is connected to the detection of ____________ (usually sunlight). Constant light or lack thereof could possible disrupt proper function.
  - This is one reason people may opt to use "light boxes" or "blackout"

curtains



Discuss: What part of the CNS is the hypothalamus located in and what organ in the endocrine system does it coordinate hormone production with?

2.3 Problems with Circadian Rhythms

- Ideally, our circadian rhythm related to sleep has us awake during the __________ and asleep during the night
- This is aided, in part, by the __________ of **melatonin** by the pineal gland in the endocrine system.
  - A rule of thumb: melatonin is produced more when we are in __________, which is determined in part by the SCN

Important

Everything is connected! The SCN is located in the hypothalamus, which conducts hormone regulation with the pituitary gland which in turn conducts the pineal gland which produces melatonin in response to the original darkness sensed by the SCN.

- There are regular and healthy ______ difference in exact tiredness pattern
  - I, your instructor, am more of a morning person, up at 4am and falling asleep early (ideally)
  - Some people are more "night owls"
  - Neither of these is bad, in ______
  - Our exactly **sleep regulation** is how we ______ between sleep and wakefulness

2.4 Temporary Disruptions of Normal Sleep

- There are several ______ circumstances that disrupt or otherwise harm our circadian rhythm of ______
  - **Jet lag** is a term that describes a ______ condition after crossing multiple time zones quickly (usually on a flight)
  - **Insomnia** is difficulty in falling and ______ asleep for long periods of time
  - **Rotating shift work or working late hours** can also impact our sleep, as we may be exposed to less light than what the human body is ______ too

Discuss: Try thinking of some other scenarios where sleep and restfulness is otherwise harmed

2.5 Insufficient Sleep

- Many of us do not get ______ sleep (wow, shocker!)

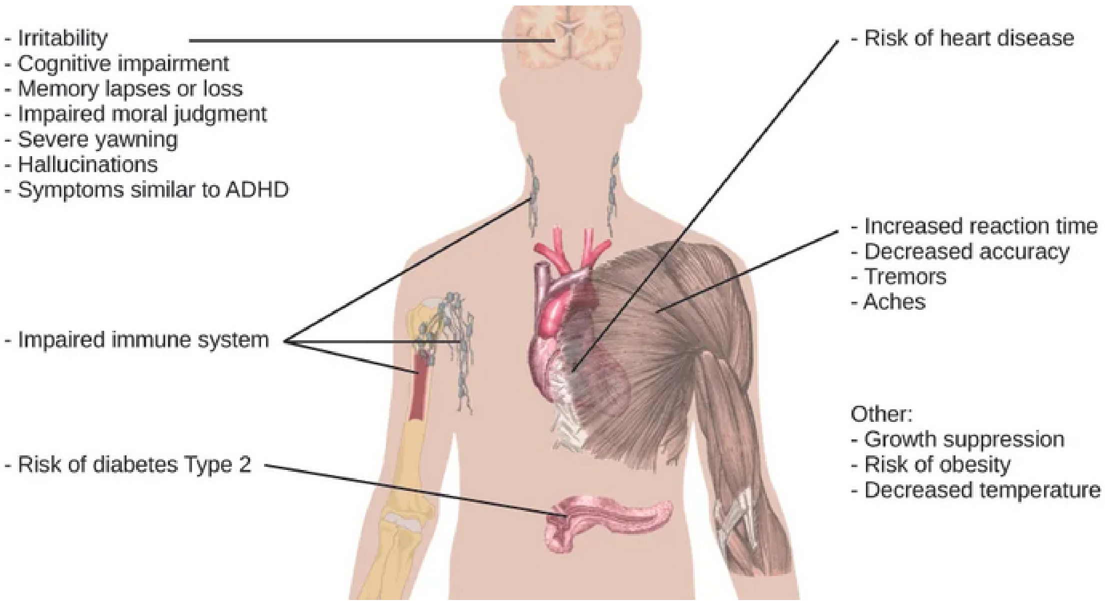
- This results in what we call **sleep debt**, or a ________ of sleep causing residual negative symptoms
- Rise in this has been attributed, in part, to the development of ________ light

> **Important**
>
> Remember that SCN? It gets impacted by artificial light similar to sunlight...

Sleep Needs at Different Ages

Age	Recommended	May be appropriate	Not recommended
0–3 months	14–17 hours	11–13 hours 18–19 hours	Fewer than 11 hours More than 19 hours
4–11 months	12–15 hours	10–11 hours 16–18 hours	Fewer than 10 hours More than 18 hours
1–2 years	11–14 hours	9–10 hours 15–16 hours	Fewer than 9 hours More than 16 hours
3–5 years	10–13 hours	8–9 hours 14 hours	Fewer than 8 hours More than 14 hours
6–13 years	9–11 hours	7–8 hours 12 hours	Fewer than 7 hours More than 12 hours
14–17 years	8–10 hours	7 hours 11 hours	Fewer than 7 hours More than 11 hours
18–25 years	7–9 hours	6 hours 10–11 hours	Fewer than 6 hours More than 11 hours
26–64 years	7–9 hours	6 hours 10 hours	Fewer than 6 hours More than 10 hours
≥65 years	7–8 hours	5–6 hours 9 hours	Fewer than 5 hours More than 9 hours

- Chronic sleep debt can lead to:
  - Mental health concerns (especially depression and ________)
  - Slowed processing speed and diminished ________
  - Extreme cases can lead to pseudo-intoxication at around 24 hours, hallucinations at 48 hours, and eventual death (in the case of fatal insomnia)



3 Sleep and Why We Sleep

3.1 Introduction

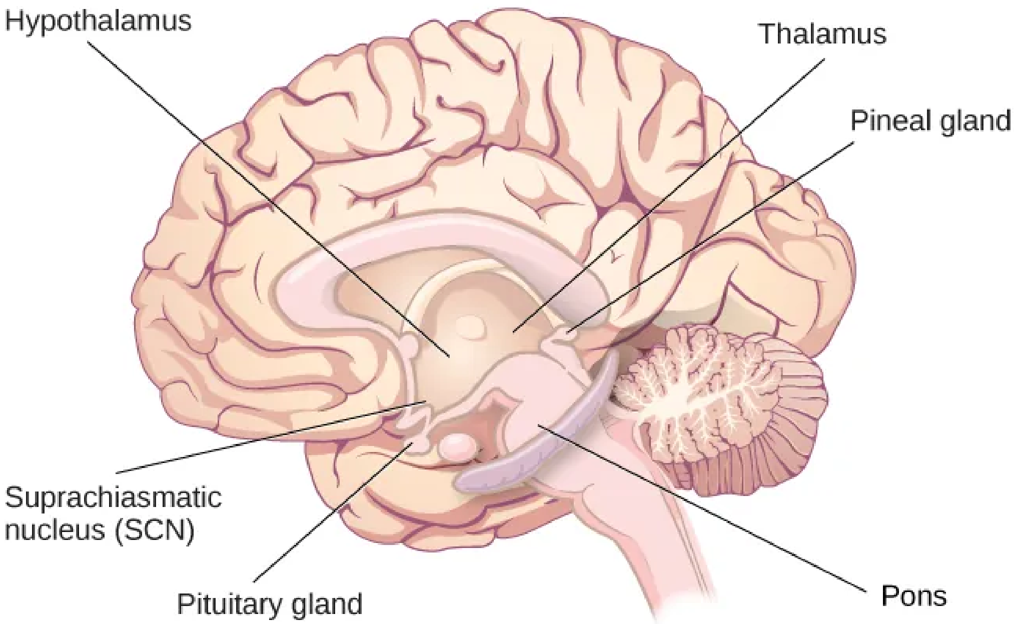
- Species differ in how much sleep they get, if any, but humans need to sleep around ________ percent of our lives

> **Important**
>
> That is a ton of time! But evidence shows we really do need this much.

3.2 What is Sleep?

- A perfect definition of sleep is hard to pin down, but:
  - It is governed by a ________ rhythm
  - It is necessary for ________
  - It is a time of relatively low physical and ________ cognitive activity
- Connecting back to biopsychology, there's a few areas of the ________ involved:
- The pons is involved in REM (more on that in a bit)
- The thalamus coordinates "slow wave" sleep

- Hypothalamus and contained SCN keep our biological ________ correct
- Pituitary gland secretes ________ hormone which is often active during sleep



? What part of the brain is the pons located in?

- (•) A) Forebrain
- ( ) B) Hindbrain
- ( ) C) Midbrain
- ( ) D) Spinal Cord

Explanation:

3.3 Why Do We Sleep?

Important

Sleep is clearly important, but why? That is actually still a question up for debate

- This is a super cool area of research in psychology, because there is still so much not well-understood in sleep
- But, we can understand a bit about why we need sleep by looking at the __________ it appears to serve and evidence of certain correlates with it

3.4 Adaptive Function of Sleep

- The adaptive functions of sleep are often viewed through the lens of __________ psychology

Discuss: Review: describe the focus of evolutionary psychology - what is it primarily concerned with?

- Be careful of non-scientific, __________ claims, even those that seem to make sense in the evolutionary scheme
  - Hypothesis 1: Sleep is __________ to help conserve energy - evidence shows that this doesn't really seem to be correlated
  - Hypothesis 2: Sleep in safe spaces keeps us safe from predators - but doesn't seem to hold up in __________ models
- Even if there is not a clear evolutionary reason why we sleep, research suggests that there are __________:
  - Lowered __________
  - Better overall physical health
  - Better __________
  - Improved __________ and other cognitive skills

3.5 Cognitive Function of Sleep

- Speaking of memory, evidence on learning and ________ of memories seems to imply that proper sleep is essential for maintaining memory

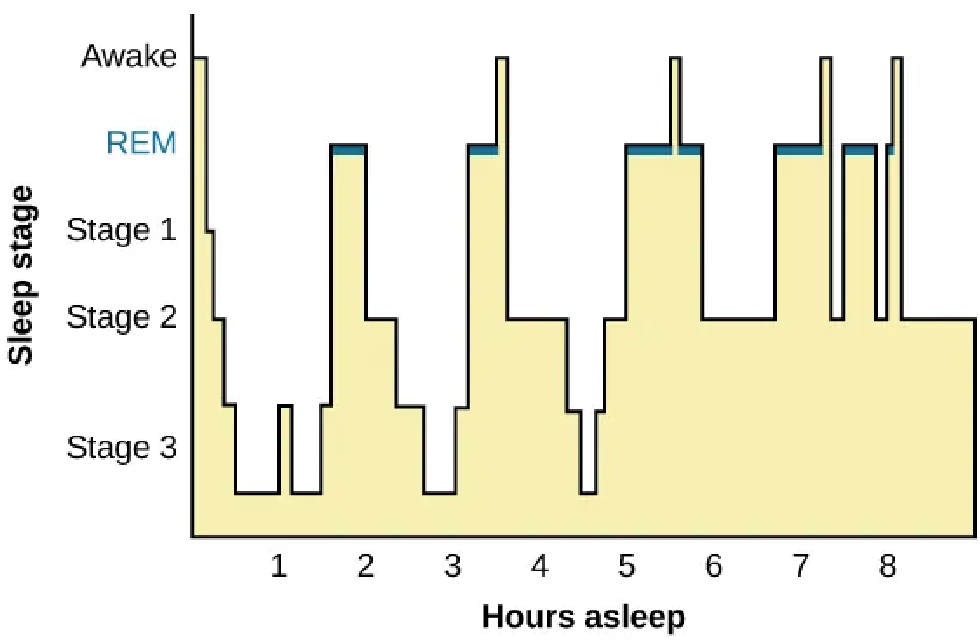
Discuss: If we say that more high quality sleep and better memory function are correlated with r = 0.95 (hypothetically), how do we describe this relationship?

- It seems sleep may also benefit ________ thinking and ________ learning as well

4 Stages of Sleep

4.1 Introduction

- As alluded to earlier, sleepiness is not an on-off switch, it is better thought of as a ________ of several different stages and states



- When awake, our brain primarily shows **beta waves** on an EEG
  - These waves are ________________, small (low amplitude) bumps on a graph

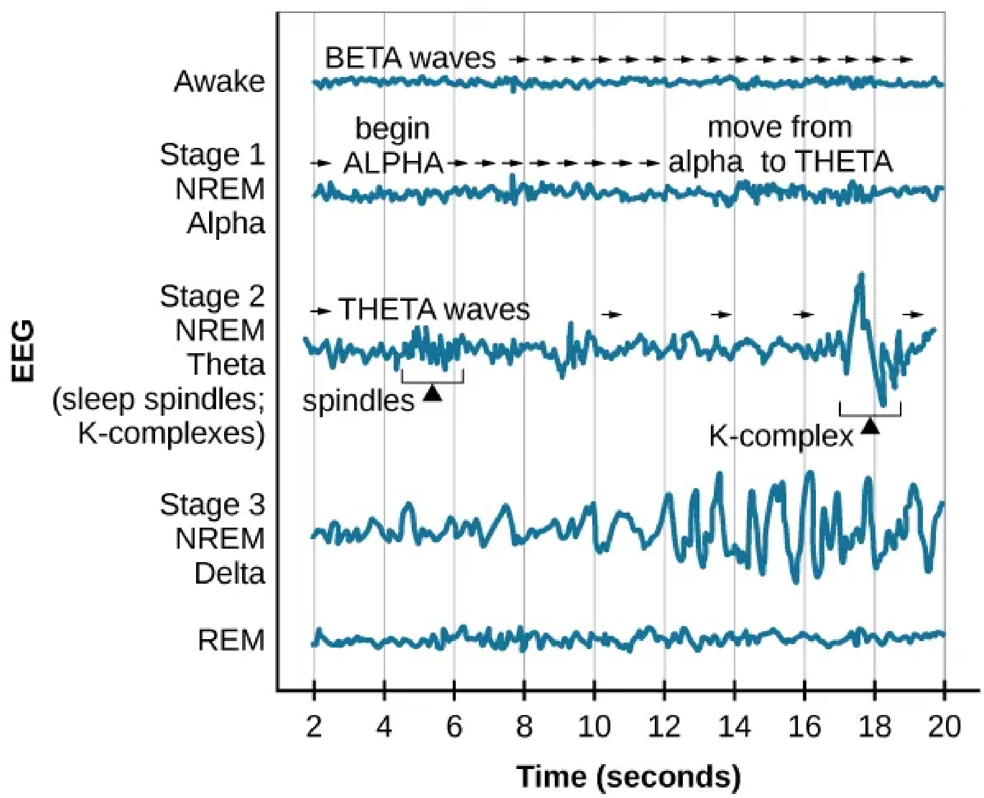
? What method does an EEG work on for imaging the brain?

- (●) A) Magnets
- ( ) B) Radiation
- ( ) C) Electricity
- ( ) D) None of the above

Explanation:

- We have 4 distinct stages of sleep: stages 1, 2, 3 and REM (covered more in the next section)

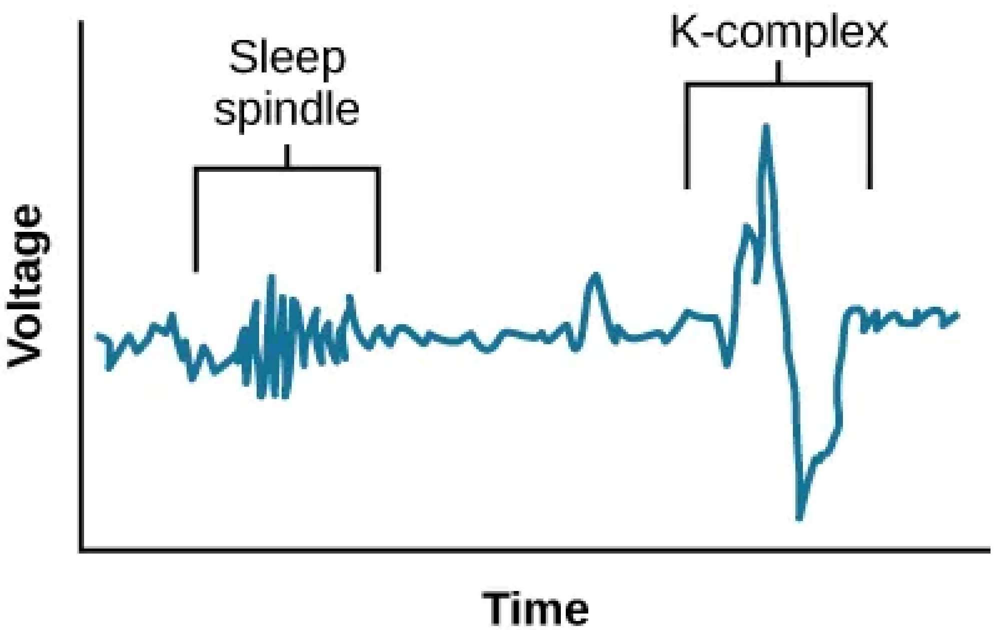
4.2 NREM Stages of Sleep



- Stage 1

- Feels almost like you aren't even asleep - more so just very relaxed
- Alpha waves with slightly larger ____________
- Eventually transition to ____________ waves with even larger amplitudes

- Stage 2
  - Deeper sleep and ____________
  - Now have **sleep spindles** with bursts of rapid ____________, thought to be related to memory and learning
  - Also **k-complexes** that seem to do with staying aware of ____________

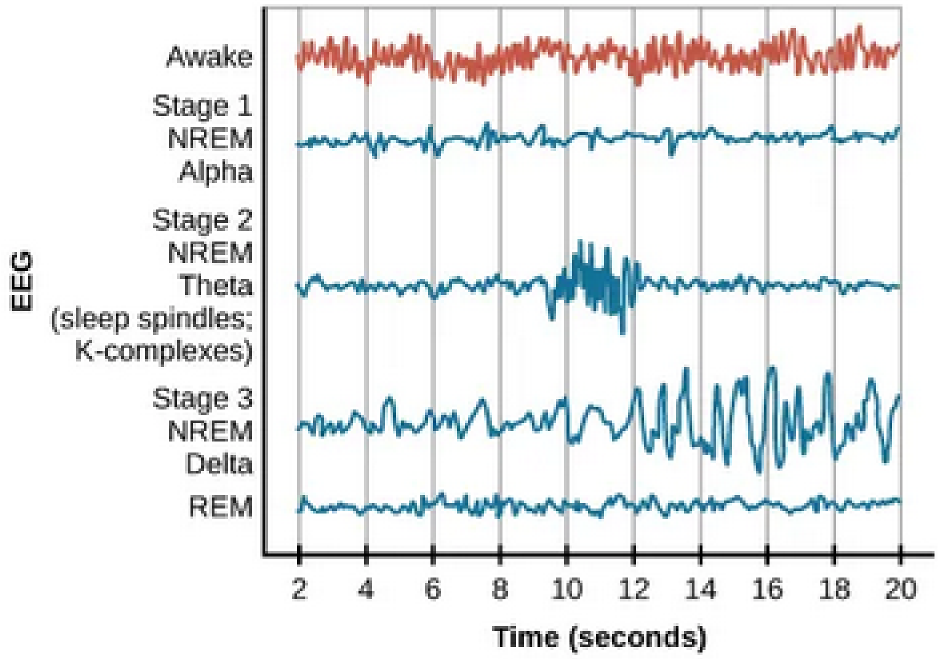


- Stage 3
  - Very ____________ sleep that should contain large **delta waves**
  - Being woken up from this state results in being very groggy

Discuss: Many people experience 'hypnic jerks' or a sudden quick muscle spasm associated with feelings of falling, what stage do you think that occurs in?

4.3 REM Sleep

- **REM (Rapid Eye Movement) Sleep** is marked by high levels of brain activity similar to when we are ______________
  - This is why it is sometimes called ______________ sleep
  - Accompanied by muscle paralysis to protect the sleeper; this is also what results in "sleep paralysis"



(b)

- REM is still being explored but has fascinating characteristics that suggests it is extraordinarily important for ______________ regulation and memory

4.4 Dreams

- Dreams and interpreting their ______________ have long been an area of interest and controversy

? Sigmund Freud was one of the earliest psychological theorists on dreams, what historical perspective of psychology is he associated with?

- (●) A) Psychoanalysis
- ( ) B) Developmental
- ( ) C) Behaviorism
- ( ) D) Functionalism

Explanation:

- Freud's perspective is that there were two __________ of dreams:
  - The **manifest content**, the actual content and happenings of the dreams
  - The **latent content**, the interpretation of the dream

Important

Remember, Freud is criticized for being a bit pre-scientific in his findings at times...

5 Sleep Problems and Disorders

5.1 Introduction

- There are several known, __________ conditions that present more severe and sustained problems than the temporary scenarios discussed earlier
- These sleep disturbances have different __________ that change the function of the sleep waves as described prior and require specialized treatment

Important

Talk with your doctor if one of these conditions personally affects you and you would like to seek treatment. I am not a physician and none of the following is medial advice!

5.2 Insomnia

- **Insomnia** is the difficulty in falling and staying asleep
  - It may appears as tossing and turning in bed, feeling "wired", waking up often, finding it difficult to relax, etc.
  - Tends to be very ____________, which only further increases the difficulty in sleeping
  - ____________ and not always one clear cause: may by psychological, related to medications, related to current events, etc.
- Treatment is best done with **Cognitive-behavioral Therapy (CBT)** which focuses on stress management and changing ____________ behaviors
  - There also exists temporary aids, i.e., "sleeping pills"

> Discuss: Have you ever experienced strange things while taking sleep aids, e.g., Nyquil

5.3 Parasomnias

- **Parasomnias** involves ____________ and unwanted motor activity, that comes in several flavors
  - These can happen across NREM or REM sleep

5.3.1 Sleepwalking

- **Sleepwalking aka somnambulism** generally occurs during slow-wave sleep and is linked to breathing problem
  - Sometimes this can involve surprisingly complex (and dangerous) behaviors
  - Safest thing to do is wake the person up and guide them back to bed

Discuss: Know of any stories of sleepwalking friends or family (or yourself)

5.3.2 REM Sleep Behavior Disorder (RBD)

- This involves the improper ____________ of muscles during REM. Because REM involves very "active" brain waves this may result in:

  These behaviors vary widely, but they can include kicking, punching, scratching, yelling, and behaving like an animal that has been frightened or attacked. People who suffer from this disorder can injure themselves or their sleeping partners when engaging in these behaviors.

5.3.3 Other Parasomnias

- **Restless leg syndrome** as the name would imply involves involuntary movement in the legs that make it difficult to fall and stay asleep
- **Night terrors** similarly intuitive name, are a sudden sense of panic in the sufferer and are often accompanied by screams and attempts to escape from the immediate environment.

5.4 Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS)

- **SIDS** tends to occur in infants younger than ____________ months old, occurring seemingly at random
  - It is best to put infants on their ____________ to sleep and to take precaution to avoid anything in cribs that may cause suffocation like additional blankets/pillows

6 Conclusion

6.1 Recap

- There are many important circadian and homeostasis-focused rhythms/cycles in our bodies that help keep us physiologically and psychologically healthy
- Sleep is one of these rhythms, and is a complex but important process that is essential for proper regulation of memory, emotion, physical health, and overall cognition
- Sleep has multiple stages and components, each with distinct characteristics and brain wave activities
- Unfortunately, sleep can be both temporarily and chronically disrupted in manners that are dangerous to our well-being

6.2 Lecture Check-in

- Get into assigned groups for our weekly group work activity!

The instructor-provided glossary may not include all terms worth memorizing, make sure you consider using the vocabulary list in you book and your own judgment to make sure you have all relevant terms